Affinity Diagram

"What can we do to combat climate change?"

CSCE 190 — Spring 2026 — Ahmed Iftikhar

Personal Habits

- Eat less red meat
- Walk or bike short trips
- Reusable water bottle
- Buy second-hand clothes
- Compost food waste
- Shorter showers
- Unplug electronics
- Carpool to work/class
- Reduce flying

⚡ Home & Energy

- Switch to LED bulbs
- Install solar panels
- Heat pump replacement
- Smart thermostat
- Better home insulation
- Energy-Star appliances
- Switch to green grid
- EV charging at home

Technology

- Carbon tracking app
- EVs & e-bikes
- AI for grid optimization
- Carbon capture tech
- Smart home automation
- Green data centers

Community & Education

- School climate curriculum
- Tree-planting events
- Beach/park cleanups
- Climate workshops
- Social media campaigns
- Community gardens
- Eco-clubs at school/work
- Local meet-ups
- Mentorship for younger kids
- Public talks & panels
- Climate-themed art / media

Policy & Systems

- Carbon tax
- Subsidize renewables
- Public transit expansion
- Stricter car emissions
- Vote pro-climate
- Building codes (green)
- Bike lane infrastructure
- Plastic bag bans
- Net-zero by 2050 pledge
- International treaties
- Fund climate research

Business & Industry

- Sustainable supply chains
- Buy local / small biz
- Green packaging
- B-Corp certification
- Remote work policies
- ESG investing
- Carbon offset programs
- Greener offices

Nature & Food

- Reforestation
- Protect wetlands
- Plant-based diets
- Reduce food waste
- Regenerative agriculture
- Pollinator gardens
- Buy seasonal produce
- Marine protection

Key Takeaways from the Affinity Diagram

1. Solutions span 7 distinct themes, from individual habits to international policy.
Climate action isn't one thing — it's a whole ecosystem of choices.

2. The biggest cluster is "Community & Education" (11 ideas).
Suggests our project should focus on awareness, social action, and behavior change.

3. "Personal Habits" + "Home & Energy" together = 17 ideas — the most actionable cluster.
These are the ideas the average person can act on this week without waiting for governments.

4. Technology and Policy ideas tend to be high-impact but low-individual-control.
These ideas point toward design opportunities: tools that connect everyday people to systemic action.

→ Project direction: Build a tool that helps individuals act on personal-habit clusters, while connecting them to community and policy actions for compounding impact.